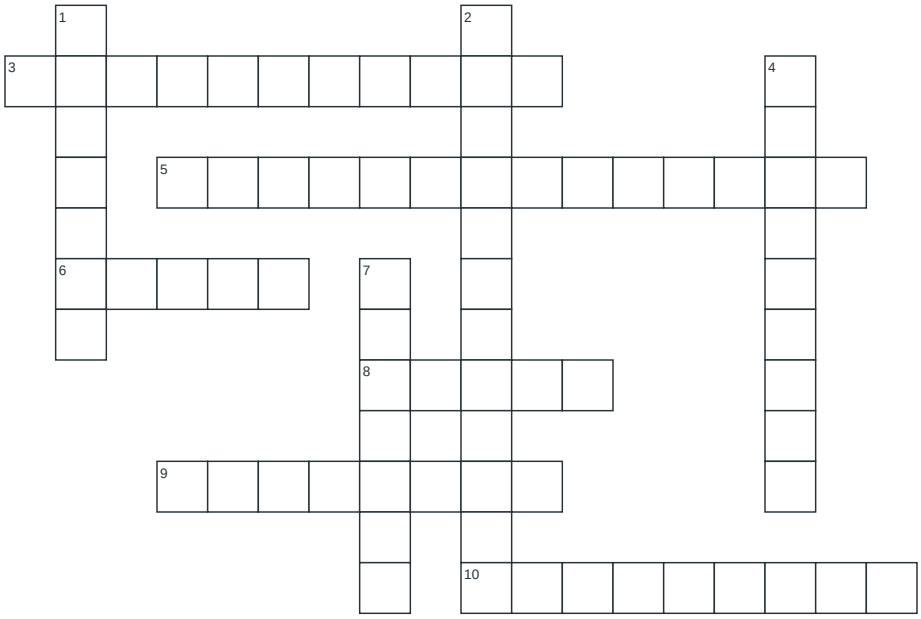
Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Easy | 10 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

3. Working together to meet a shared goal.

5. Duty a character accepts for a choice or its effects.

6. Broad subject such as friendship, rather than a complete message.

8. Insight about life developed through a literary text.

9. Specific textual information supporting an interpretation.

10. Giving up something valued to uphold a commitment.

DOWN

1. Commitment to a person or promise despite personal cost.

2. Results of characters' choices that can reveal a story's message.

4. Honesty and adherence to principles even when no one is watching.

7. Repeated arrangement of ideas or events that helps reveal meaning.

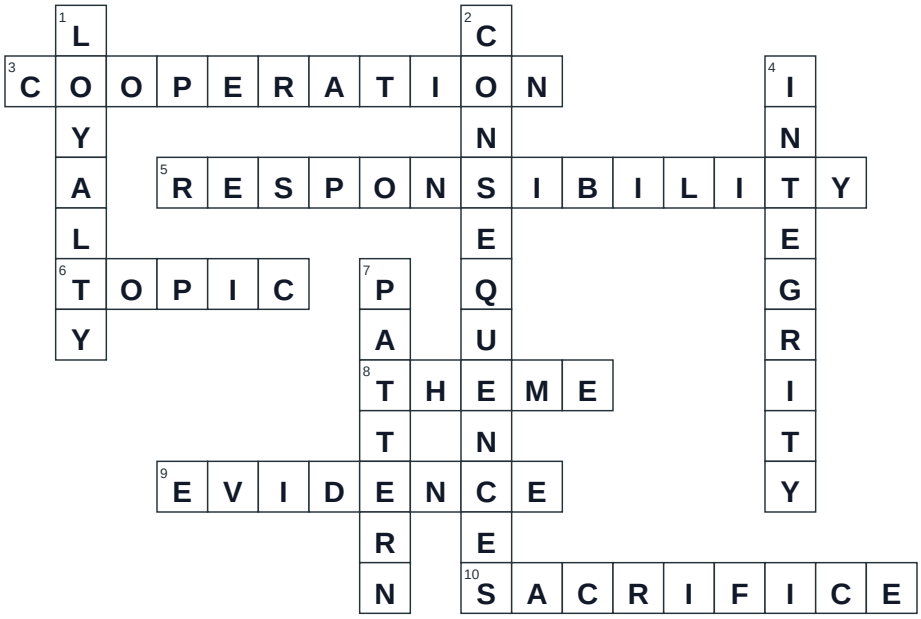
© 2026 Teach Arcade

Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Easy | 10 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

3. Cooperation
5. Responsibility
6. Topic
8. Theme
9. Evidence
10. Sacrifice

DOWN

1. Loyalty
2. Consequences
4. Integrity
7. Pattern

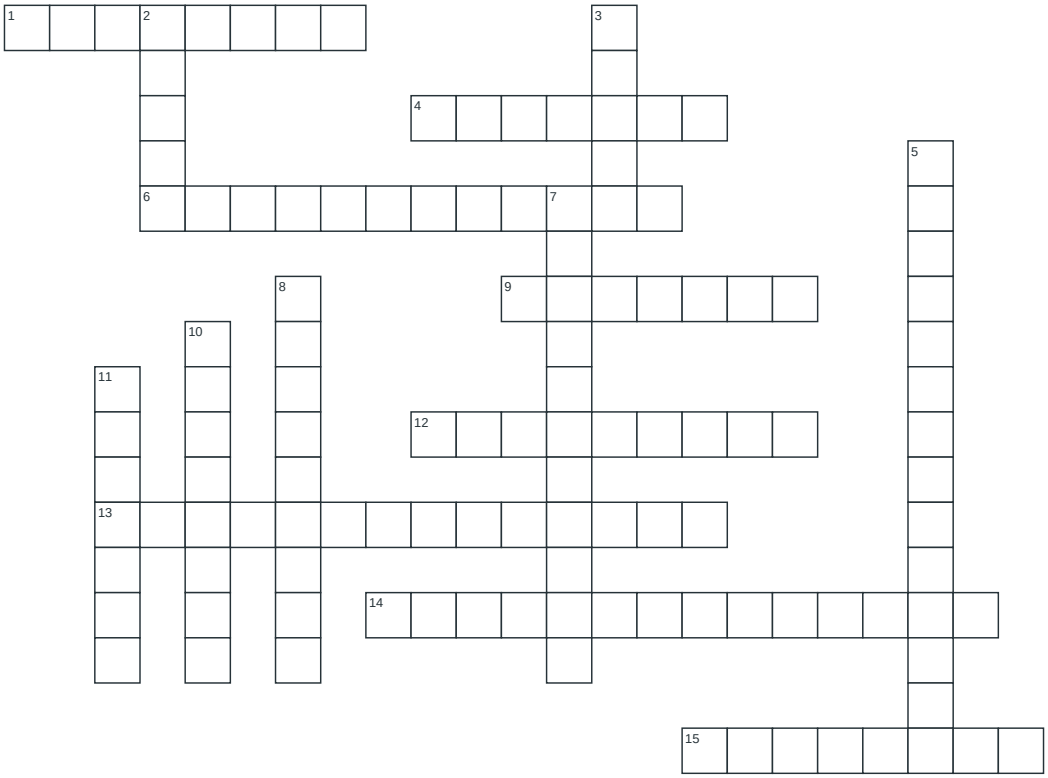
© 2026 Teach Arcade

Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Medium | 15 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

1. Difference between characters' choices and outcomes that can reveal a theme.

4. Repeated arrangement of ideas or events that helps reveal meaning.

6. Results of characters' choices that can reveal a story's message.

9. Commitment to a person or promise despite personal cost.

12. Giving up something valued to uphold a commitment.

13. Reasoned explanation of what a text means.

14. Duty a character accepts for a choice or its effects.

15. Specific textual information supporting an interpretation.

DOWN

2. Broad subject such as friendship, rather than a complete message.

3. Insight about life developed through a literary text.

5. Broad conclusion that becomes weak when it exceeds the text's support.

7. Working together to meet a shared goal.

8. Honesty and adherence to principles even when no one is watching.

10. Strong desire for achievement that may help or harm relationships.

11. Understanding gained from examining experience or a text.

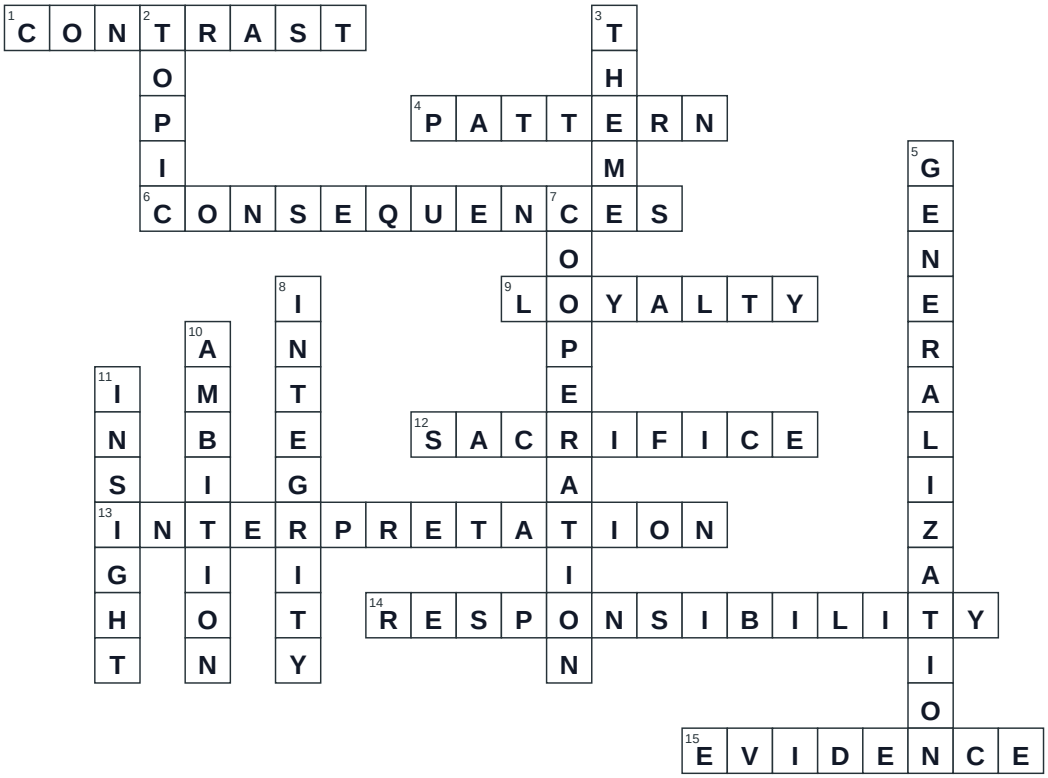
© 2026 Teach Arcade

Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Medium | 15 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

1. Contrast
4. Pattern
6. Consequences
9. Loyalty
12. Sacrifice
13. Interpretation
14. Responsibility
15. Evidence

DOWN

2. Topic
3. Theme
5. Generalization
7. Cooperation
8. Integrity
10. Ambition
11. Insight

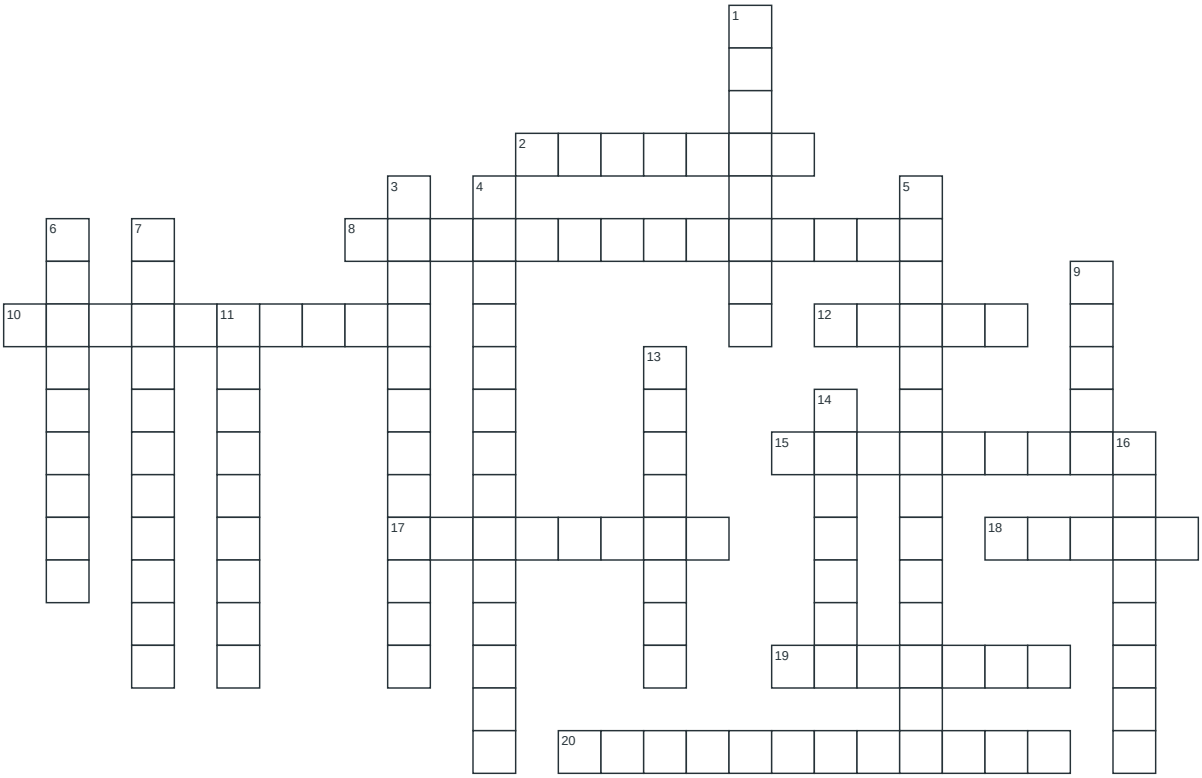
© 2026 Teach Arcade

Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

2. Commitment to a person or promise despite personal cost.

8. Broad conclusion that becomes weak when it exceeds the text's support.

10. Things a character considers most important.

12. Insight about life developed through a literary text.

15. Giving up something valued to uphold a commitment.

17. Strong desire for achievement that may help or harm relationships.

18. Arguable statement about a text's meaning that requires support.

19. Understanding gained from examining experience or a text.

20. Results of characters' choices that can reveal a story's message.

DOWN

1. Difference between characters' choices and outcomes that can reveal a theme.

3. Continued effort despite setbacks.

4. Duty a character accepts for a choice or its effects.

5. Reasoned explanation of what a text means.

6. Desire to ask questions and learn.

7. Working together to meet a shared goal.

9. Broad subject such as friendship, rather than a complete message.

11. Honesty and adherence to principles even when no one is watching.

13. Exchange of views that can develop a message about listening.

14. Repeated arrangement of ideas or events that helps reveal meaning.

16. Specific textual information supporting an interpretation.

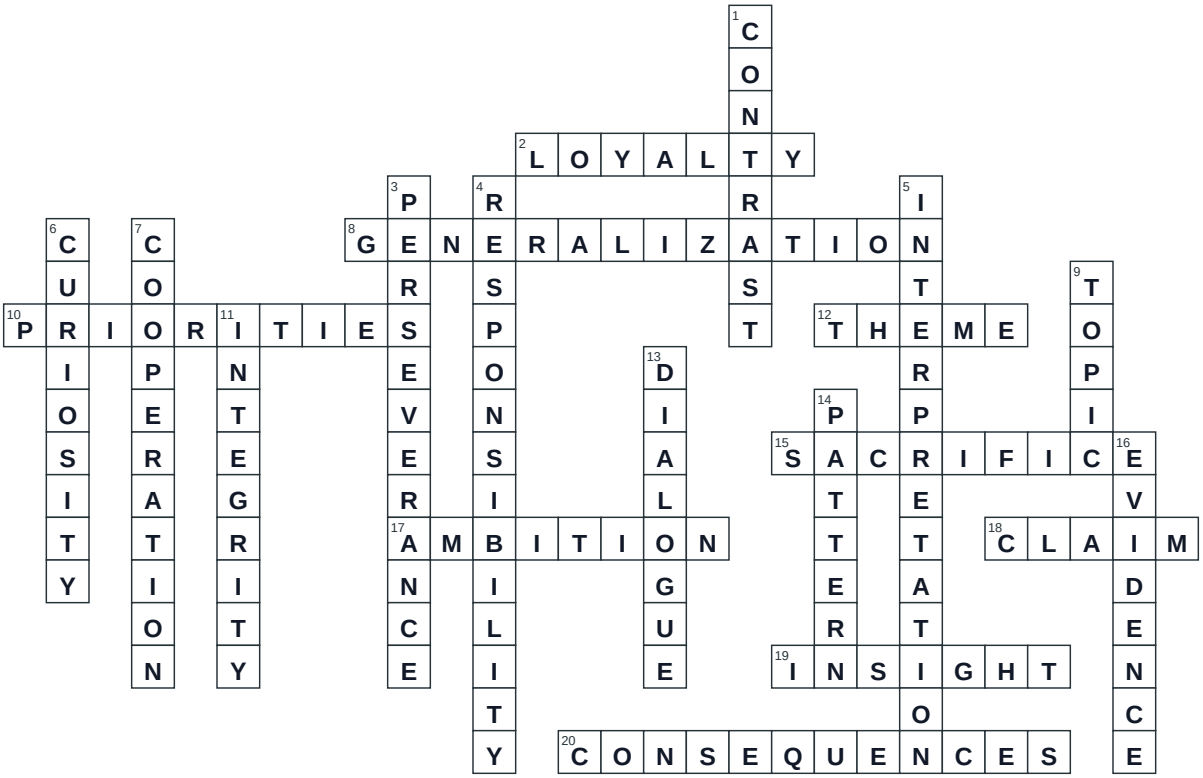
© 2026 Teach Arcade

Theme and Central Meaning Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

2. Loyalty
8. Generalization
10. Priorities
12. Theme
15. Sacrifice
17. Ambition
18. Claim
19. Insight
20. Consequences

DOWN

1. Contrast
3. Perseverance
4. Responsibility
5. Interpretation
6. Curiosity
7. Cooperation
9. Topic
11. Integrity
13. Dialogue
14. Pattern
16. Evidence

© 2026 Teach Arcade